

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 5♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣A

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠4

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 7NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 5♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦A

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5
 ♥ 8 6 3
 ♦ 10 9 6 5 4
 ♣ A 9 6

♠ A K Q 9 8 3

♥ 2

♦ A K

♣ K Q J 8



♠ 6
 ♥ A J 10 9 7
 ♦ Q J 7 3
 ♣ 10 4 2

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ 7 5 3

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by North			
Lead: ♦Q			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 4
♥ K J 9
♦ A K Q J 9
♣ K Q

♠ Q 10 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 9 8 5 3 2



♠ J 3

♥ A Q 10 8 6

♦ 10 3

♣ J 10 7 4

♠ K 9 8 7 5

♥ 7 4

♦ 7 6 5 4

♣ A 6

EAST makes a positive 3♥ response to WEST's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

WEST only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the EAST hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 6 5 4 2

♥ 9 8 7

♦ 10 5 2

♣ 6 4

♠ K Q

♥ K 6

♦ A 4

♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2



♠ 10 8 3

♥ A 10 5 3

♦ J 9 7 3

♣ 10 8

♠ A 9 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ A 5

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made. SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♠4			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q 6 4 3

♥ K 5

♦ K 7 3

♣ A K

♠ 8

♥ Q 10

♦ J 9 6 5 4 2

♣ Q J 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 5 2

♥ A J 7 4 3

♦ A Q

♣ 9 8

♠ 10 7

♥ 9 8 6 2

♦ 10 8

♣ 10 7 6 5 4

WEST has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When EAST supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that EAST has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that EAST will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			
7NT by West			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 6 5

♥ 7 2

♦ 10 9 5

♣ A 9 7 2

♠ J 7 3

♥ A J 10 9 8

♦ 8 3 2

♣ Q 8



♠ 9 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ A 7 6 4

♣ 10 5 4 3

♠ A K 2

♥ K Q 6 5

♦ K Q J

♣ K J 6

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♣

Pass

5♦

Pass

4NT

All Pass

5♥

5♥ by North

Lead: ♦A